

Is it true that the energy consumption of AI is trivial and we will all live in palaces in the sky?

Posted by u/Radfactor • • 0 points • 50 comments

That there is only upside and no cost? That free lunches are routinely eaten, especially by Silicon Valley tech bros, due to the largesse of billionaires who buy them pizza once a week?

That all the promises of the tech bros will come true, and we will live in paradise?

That the AI revolution will not end up as a socially destructive, predatory data mining mechanism, unlike social media and the Internet in general.

That cryptocurrency has uses other than financial speculation, tax evasion, funding terrorism, and kitty porn?

That all the high flying promises will be kept, and the people producing them actually care about things other than getting as rich as possible by any means, and regardless of any cost?

Comments

u/Radfactor • 1 points • 2025-04-22 22:13 UTC

they're definitely issues of noise, but those can be addressed if I have zoning. They're also issues of eminent domain as they're needing to import more energy.

The major effect that we're facing is the competition for resources, principally electricity, but also to some extent water, which means prices for consumers could double over the next five years.

And of course, from a global perspective, there are now numerous coal plants that are remaining online because we can't bring new energy sources online quickly enough to meet the demand.

and while people like to pretend that nuclear energy is the magic bullet, that is still restricted to reactors that create nuclear waste, for which we have no solution, and where there is a greater than zero possibility for a meltdown due to natural disaster or human error.

so while I'm 100% pro expansion of AI, I think it's insanity not too knowledge these hidden costs that accompany it. because if we acknowledge them, then we will be better able to deal with them.

u/Radfactor • 1 points • 2025-04-22 20:49 UTC

> Report: upload ratio currently 44%

Clearly, most users prefer to be in denial. again, I want to reinforce I am not opposed to the geometric expansion of computing power for AI, but I'm merely employing people to also acknowledge the impacts. rationality require requires considering the downside as well as the upside.

Conclusion: a major majority of those voting on this post are formally not rational.

(that would explain a lot about our society!)

